Vision figures — enrichment, not a text lever

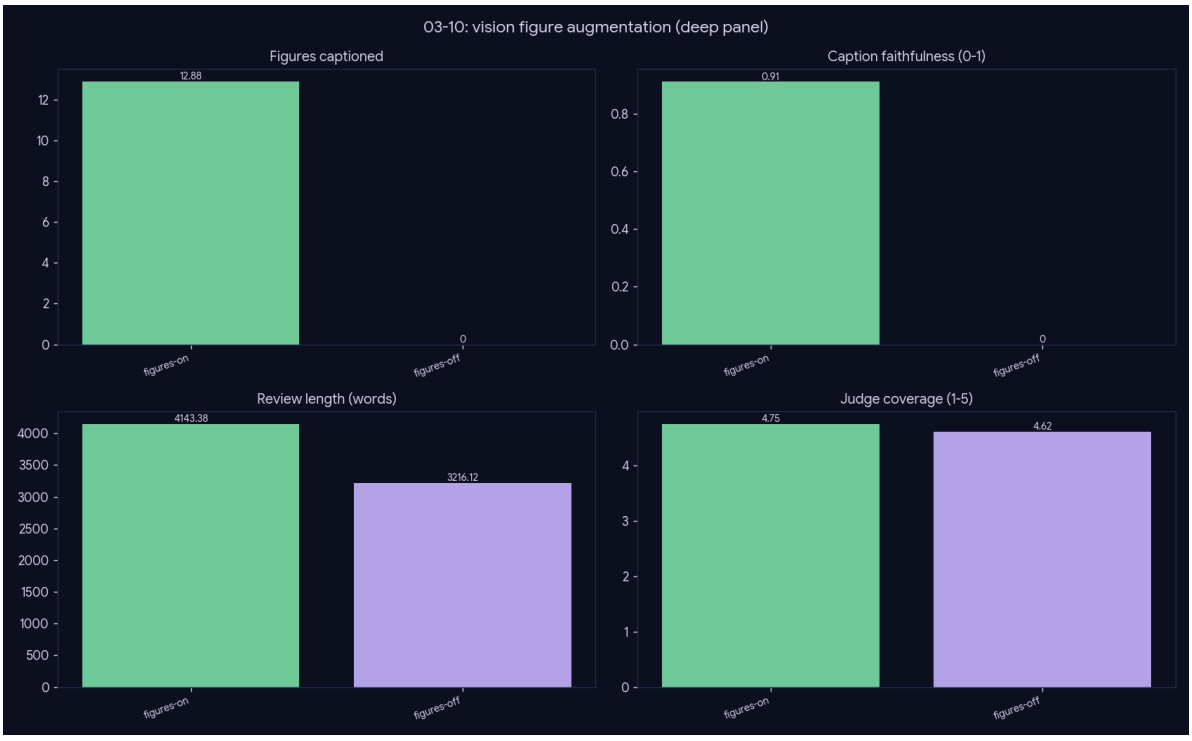
arxivkg · generation · vision figures

What we did

Toggle the figure gallery on/off over the 27-topic battery. With it on, a Gemma-4-26B-Vision pass selects architecture diagrams / result plots from the landmark papers and writes captions; each figure is checked by a caption-faithfulness tripwire (does the caption match the image?). Scored on the text metric vector + 4-axis judge, plus the gallery's own caption-faithfulness.

Results (mean over 27 topics)

figures	n figures	fig checked	caption faithfulness	words	grounded	gold recall	j coverage
figures-on	12.88	12.88	0.91	4143.38	47.88	0.85	4.75
figures-off	0.0	0.0	0.0	3216.12	47.75	0.92	4.62



Conclusion

The figure gallery is an enrichment feature, not a lever on the text. With it on, each review carries 12.88 figures at 0.91 caption-faithfulness and grows by ∼1000 words (3216 → 4143), but the 4-axis *textual* judge is unchanged (coverage 4.67 vs 4.65, grounding flat) — as expected, since

the judge reads text, not images. The figures' value lives in their *own* metric (caption-faithfulness 0.91), i.e. verified visual grounding the text judge structurally cannot see. **Ship it as an option**: it makes the review materially richer (diagrams + plots a reader wants) at the cost of ∼1000 words and a vision pass, without touching textual quality — a clean additive feature, neither a quality win nor a regression on the text axes. **Caveat:** the only quality guarantee here is caption-faithfulness; an unfaithful caption is the failure mode the tripwire exists to catch (0.91 pass rate).